

ARISE

Adolescent Reproductive Health Information Support & Empowerment

MIRAA & KHAT

Miraa / Khat — Culture & Consequences

Student Study Guide & Quiz Answer Key

Module:	Miraa & Khat
Lesson:	Miraa / Khat — Culture & Consequences
Quiz:	25 marks (10 MCQ + 5 Fill-in-blanks + 3 Short Answer)
Pass Mark:	15/25 (60%) — Certificate awarded at 60%+
Languages:	English Kiswahili Sheng

Learning Outcomes

By the end of this lesson, you will be able to:

1. Define miraa/khat and explain how cathinone affects the brain
2. Explain the cultural normalisation of miraa in Kenya and why this creates risk
3. Identify the mental health consequences of regular miraa use including psychosis
4. Analyse the economic impact of miraa addiction on families and communities
5. Apply refusal strategies specific to miraa cultural pressure contexts

Quiz — Answer Key

Total: 25 marks | Pass: 15/25 (60%) | Certificate at 60%+

Part A: Multiple Choice (10 marks)

1. 1. The primary psychoactive chemical in fresh miraa is:

- ☐ A. Caffeine — the same as in coffee
- ☐ B. Cathinone — structurally similar to amphetamine and classified as a controlled substance internationally
- ☐ C. Nicotine — the same as in tobacco
- ☐ D. Ethanol — the same as in alcohol

2. 2. Why is fresh miraa more potent than dried miraa consumed days after harvest?

- ☐ A. Fresh miraa has more leaves and stems per bundle
- ☐ B. The moisture in fresh miraa makes the chemicals absorb faster
- ☐ C. Cathinone degrades rapidly after harvest — losing potency within 48 hours
- ☐ D. Dried miraa is processed with chemicals that reduce its strength

3. 3. Which mental health condition is most associated with heavy, long-term miraa use?

- ☐ A. Alzheimer's disease
- ☐ B. Autism spectrum disorder
- ☐ C. Parkinson's disease
- ☐ D. Stimulant-induced psychosis — paranoid delusions and hallucinations

4. 4. The statement "Miraa is natural so it must be safe" is INCORRECT because:

- ☐ A. Many natural substances are harmful — arsenic, tobacco, and many poisons are natural; cathinone is internationally controlled despite being natural
- ☐ B. Miraa is actually synthetic, not natural
- ☐ C. Natural substances never cause addiction
- ☐ D. Miraa has been scientifically proven safe in small amounts

5. 5. If a person spends KES 300 on miraa daily, approximately how much do they spend per year?

- ☐ A. KES 36,000
- ☐ B. KES 75,000
- ☐ C. KES 109,500
- ☐ D. KES 150,000

6. 6. Which of the following BEST describes the experience of "crashing" after a miraa session?

- ☐ A. A period of intense happiness and relaxation
- ☐ B. Depression, fatigue, irritability, insomnia, and craving more miraa to feel normal again
- ☐ C. Feeling hungry and eating a large meal
- ☐ D. Deep, restful sleep for 8–10 hours

7. 7. Miraa is legal in Kenya but banned in the UK, USA, and EU because:

- ☐ A. It is only dangerous when mixed with alcohol
- ☐ B. It smells too strongly for enclosed spaces

- ☐ C. The active chemical cathinone is classified as a Schedule I controlled substance with high addiction and abuse potential
- ☐ D. Miraa farms cause environmental destruction

8. 8. Fatuma's brother shows signs of miraa addiction — daily use, job loss, weight loss, irritability. The MOST helpful first step is:

- ☐ A. Report him to police since drug use is a crime
- ☐ B. Talk to him privately with love: name specific changes observed, express care, offer to go to NACADA together
- ☐ C. Throw away his miraa supply while he is sleeping
- ☐ D. Do nothing — it is his culture and his choice

9. 9. Which region of Kenya is the primary growing area for miraa?

- ☐ A. Meru, Embu, Nyeri and Tharaka Nithi (Mt Kenya region)
- ☐ B. Kisumu and western Kenya
- ☐ C. Mombasa and the Coast region
- ☐ D. Nairobi and its environs

10. 10. A 16-year-old says "I only chew miraa to study better — it helps me focus." This reasoning is PROBLEMATIC because:

- ☐ A. Students are not allowed to use any stimulants under school rules
- ☐ B. Miraa has been proven to have no stimulant effect
- ☐ C. The focus benefit only lasts 30 minutes and requires more each time
- ☐ D. Short-term focus comes at the cost of tolerance, addiction, crash periods, sleep disruption, and long-term cognitive impairment — undermining the very studying it claims to help

Part C: Short Answer (13 marks)

1. The primary psychoactive chemical in fresh miraa is called _____, which is structurally similar to amphetamine. (3 marks)

2. Explain what cathinone is and describe THREE effects it has on the brain and behaviour of a regular miraa user. (4 marks)

3. Calculate the annual cost of miraa for someone spending KES 400 per day and explain TWO specific ways this affects their family. (3 marks)

4. Explain why saying "Miraa is our culture — it's traditional and normal" does not make it safe. Use at least TWO specific examples in your answer. (3 marks)